

The Internet

Only a few years ago, checking results or getting admissions for professional courses meant standing in long queues and braving the rain. Although standing in queues has not been eliminated totally, information about colleges and their admission procedure is now available online.

Being 'online' or using the Internet is a term now commonly used during conversations between students, professionals and even homemakers. Want to be the first to know your university exam results? Get the latest market quotes? Want the best recipes? Just go online!

Before it became ubiquitous, nobody believed that the common man could have access to the Internet. Only corporate users and researchers in universities were among the lucky few to have access. Thankfully, all this has changed for the better.

Awareness, for one, has increased a great deal and people are constantly in touch with the latest happenings around the planet. The Internet is omnipresent and people ignoring it or trying not to use it are considered thick.

Today, Internet connections are not restricted to merely the dial-up kind and users are fast moving on to broadband, although its penetration is still limited. Nonetheless, the good part is that people are now more connected than ever before.

But who fuels this? Where is the Internet based? More importantly, what really is this Internet? How did it suddenly become such an integral part of our lives? Is it a bad thing or a good thing? Is it going to last? Is it helping us?

In this book, we will talk about all this and more but in a manner that will make you understand what it is and how you can use it best. We will also talk about future technologies that will transform the manner in which we use the Internet today.

So if there was ever a question you had about the Internet, but didn't know whom to ask, you're holding the right book!